



Model

1 Identification and Application:

- Most texts require readers to interpret the text evidence to understand intent, meaning or context.
- Inferences based on text evidence can support an interpretation or analysis as powerfully as explicitly stated evidence.
- Make multiple inferences throughout an informational or literary text.
- Not all textual evidence has weight; examine all evidence to determine its validity.
- Make inferences by looking at several aspects of an informational text or by examining characters, setting, and plot events in a literary work:
 - Look for a series of facts or events in a text that are related. *Statistics* refers to the study of the collection, analysis, interpretation, presentation, and organization of data and can provide important textual evidence.
 - Think about any prior knowledge related to these facts or events.
 - Combine prior knowledge with evidence directly stated in the text.
 - Infer new understanding of a topic that can be used as textual evidence to support an analysis.
 - A generalization is a general statement or concept obtained by inference after examining specific cases. Analyze this kind of text evidence closely to determine whether the generalization or inference is valid.

2 Model :

In an informational text such as *Outliers: The Story of Success*, the author must include evidence from research he or she has conducted in order to support the claims made in the text. The reader identifies the text evidence and evaluates it, making a decision about its relevance and accuracy.

3 Let's look at the first paragraph of *Outliers: The Story of Success*, and identify the claim, or topic that the author presents:

- 4 For almost a generation, psychologists around the world have been engaged in a spirited debate over a question that most of us would consider to have been settled years ago. The question is this: is there such a thing as innate talent? The obvious answer is yes. Not every hockey player born in January ends up playing at the professional level. Only some do— the innately talented ones.

Achievement is talent plus preparation. The problem with this view is that the closer psychologists look at the **careers of the gifted, the smaller the role innate talent seems to play and the bigger the role preparation seems to play.**

- 5 The first few sentences introduce the topic and present the question that the author will attempt to answer. Gladwell suggests that most people feel that there is such a thing as innate talent: “the obvious answer is yes.” But then he submits that there is a problem with this point of view, for psychologists suggest that preparation is more important to success than innate talent. “The closer psychologists look at the careers of the gifted,” he writes, “the smaller the role innate talent seems to play and the bigger the role preparation seems to play.” Now, as readers, we have to look at the evidence that Malcolm Gladwell presents to support this point of view.
- 6 In the second paragraph, the author cites a study done in the early 1990s by a psychologist, K. Anders Ericsson, at the Berlin Academy of Music. Notice that the author gives the name of the researcher, and the date and location of the study. These specific details give credibility to the text evidence. The author also includes other relevant details about the procedure used to conduct the study:
 - 7 With the help of the Academy’s professors, they divided the school’s violinists into **three groups. In the first group were the stars**, the students with the potential to become world-class soloists. **In the second were those judged to be merely “good.” In the third were students who were unlikely to ever play professionally** and who intended to be music teachers in the public school system. All of the violinists were then asked the same question: **over the course of your entire career, ever since you first picked up the violin, how many hours have you practiced?**
- 8 While the numbers do give credibility, the reader should also read closely to look for examples of faulty logic. For example, the text states that the Academy’s professors helped divide the students. The text does not include the criteria the professors used. As a reader, you might conclude that the professors’ opinions of the students might have created bias when choosing them for specific groups.
- 9 Next, the author states the question that the researchers asked all of the violinists. This is an important detail to include. “Over the course of your entire career, ever since you first picked up the violin, how many hours have you practiced?” By the time they had reached the age of twenty, after beginning violin lessons at the age of five, the elite performers had each totaled ten thousand hours of practice. By contrast, the merely good students had totaled eight thousand hours, and the future music teachers had totaled just over four thousand hours. The third paragraph provides the details that answer the question in the second paragraph. The numerical information the students make available to Ericsson and his colleagues is called statistics, and refers to the study of the collection, analysis, interpretation, presentation, and organization of data.
- 10 Readers need to evaluate this text evidence, as the text may contain faulty logic. The statistics about practice time, as described in the second and third paragraphs, might be considered anecdotal evidence, or reports from non-scientific observers. The author does not explain how the researchers verified the number of hours that the violinists said they had practiced. Also, in the third paragraph, the author writes,

“In those first few years, everyone practiced roughly the same amount, about two or three hours a week.”
The words “about” and “roughly” indicate generalizations, and suggest that this was not a controlled experiment.
